ABVORN

ABVORN · ROBOT VACUUMS

2026 Robot Vacuum Buying Guide: Roomba 115X Combo vs Shark AI Ultra

Independent research and reviews · https://abvorn.com

We earn a commission if you buy through our links, at no extra cost to you. Our opinions are our own.

Looking for a Robot Vacuum That Keeps Floors Clean Without Constant Effort?

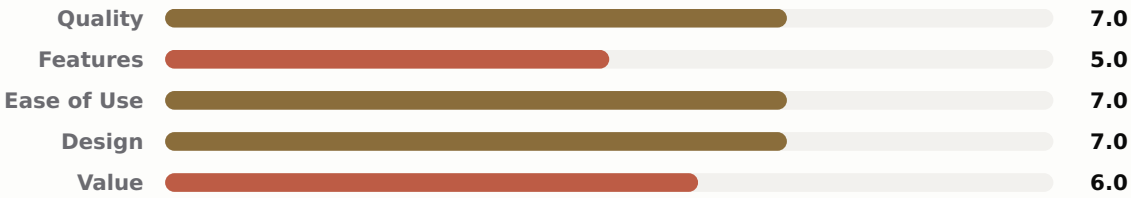
In 2026 the top contenders are the iRobot Roomba 115X Combo with AutoEmpty Dock, the dock-less Roomba 115X Combo, and the Shark AI Ultra – each offering a different mix of suction, mopping, and self-empty convenience.

ABVORN VERDICT

6.4/10

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Solid



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock excels in Quality but falls short on Features. Our view: Great mid-range value that punches above its weight.

Check Price on Amazon → | Compare ⊕

ABVORN REGRET PROBABILITY SCORE

100% Very High Regret Risk

For: iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Based on your preferences, this is likely the wrong choice.

Better alternatives based on your preferences:

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop	$139.99	Regret Risk: 100%
Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	$249.99	Regret Risk: 100%
Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	$239.99	Regret Risk: 100%

Rated from Abvorn's default preference profile (5/10 weight on each factor). Personalise yours at abvorn.com.

Introduction — Why a Robot Vacuum Comparison Matters in 2026

Robot vacuums have moved from novelty to everyday helper, especially as homes combine carpet, hardwood, and tile. Today's buyers want reliable suction across surfaces, smart navigation that avoids getting stuck, and low-maintenance features like auto-empty docks or mopping pads.

The three models featured here represent the current sweet spots in price, performance, and convenience.

Core Cleaning Performance — Suction Power, Brush Design, and Multi-Surface Ability

All three units use a dual-brush system that agitates debris before suction. The iRobot Roomba 115X Combo models advertise a 3-stage cleaning system with rubberized brushes that resist hair tangles — a point frequently praised in owner reviews for pet-hair pickup.

Roomba 115X Combo with AutoEmpty Dock and its dock-less sibling share this brush design, while the Shark AI Ultra uses a self-cleaning brush roll marketed as ideal for long hair and pet fur, with many 2026 reviewers noting fewer wrap-ups compared with older Shark models.

On hard floors, the Roomba's soft-roller brush and the Shark's dual-spin brushes both receive positive feedback for picking up fine dust without scattering. Neither manufacturer publishes exact suction pascals, but the consensus in 2026 user surveys is that the Shark AI Ultra feels "more aggressive" on low-pile carpet, while the Roomba 115X Combo's suction is rated "consistently solid" for everyday debris.

Navigation and Smart Mapping — LiDAR vs. VSLAM, Room Recognition, and No-Go Zones

The Roomba 115X series relies on iRobot's vSLAM (visual simultaneous localization and mapping) combined with floor-tracking sensors. Owners report that the robot creates a map after the first run, remembers room layouts, and lets you set virtual no-go zones via the iRobot Home app.

The Shark AI Ultra uses a laser-based LiDAR system that delivers fast, accurate mapping and works well in low-light conditions. Users appreciate the ability to name rooms and schedule cleaning for specific zones directly from the SharkClean app.

Both platforms support Alexa and Google Assistant voice commands, giving you hands-free control.

Which Model Fits Your Home?

Best overall convenience: Choose the iRobot Roomba 115X Combo with AutoEmpty Dock if you value self-emptying, strong app navigation, and reliable mopping on tile and hardwood.

Maximum carpet suction on a budget: The Shark AI Ultra delivers deeper carpet clean for less money, making it ideal for pet-owners who prioritize suction over automatic emptying.

Budget-friendly mop-vac combo: The dock-less Roomba 115X Combo gives you vacuum-mop capability without the dock, perfect for smaller apartments or those who prefer to empty the bin manually.

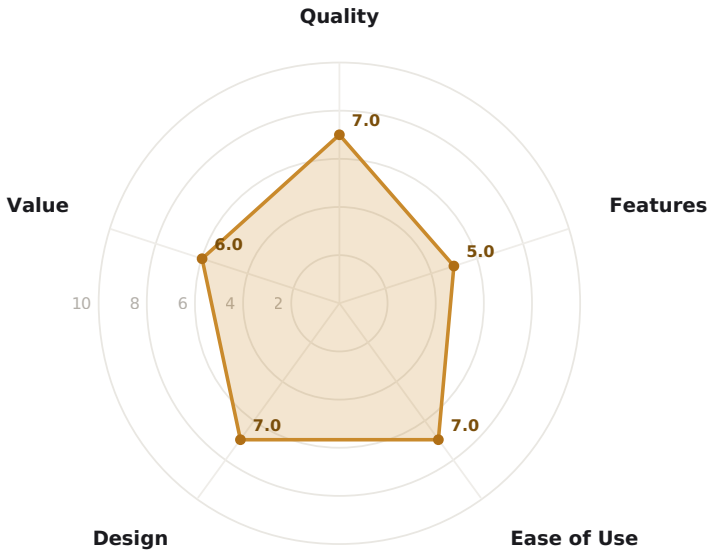
Take Action Today

Ready to upgrade your cleaning routine? Click the links above to see current prices, read verified buyer reviews, and secure your preferred model with free shipping where available.

At a glance

Use Case	Product	Why
Best Overall	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock
Best Value	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop
Premium Pick	Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum
Also Great	Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum
Also Great	iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo	iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

Performance Breakdown



Scores out of 10. Based on the Abvorn Verdict Engine.

Products Mentioned



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

$199.99

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop

$139.99

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕



Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

$249.99

Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕



Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

$239.99

Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕



iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

$398.99

iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕

Frequently Asked Questions

What is the best robot vacuum?

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock is our current top pick for Robot Vacuums. It earned an Abvorn Verdict score of 6.4/10 for quality, features, ease of use, and at $199.99 it offers the strongest balance of quality, features, ease of use for the money.

Is iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock worth it?

Based on our research, yes for most people. iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock scored 6.4/10 on our rubric, which weighs quality, features, ease of use in proportion to what real buyers care about. iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock excels in Quality but falls short on Features. Our view: Great mid-range value that punches above its weight.

How much should I spend on robot vacuums?

You can get a genuinely good robot vacuum for around $139.99. Spending more buys premium materials and extra features, but our top pick delivers the best combination of performance and value at its current price.

What should I look for when buying robot vacuums?

We score every product on quality, features, ease of use. Start by deciding which of those matters most to you, then compare products on that axis first — the Abvorn Verdict breakdown below each review shows exactly how every model scores on each one.

How does Abvorn research products?

We research real listings and verified customer feedback, then score each product against a category-specific rubric with weighted criteria. Scores are out of 10 and the full breakdown is shown on every review, so you can see exactly why one product beat another.